

Why The Wii U Failed

A deep dive into the statistics of the Wii U and its competitors

by Josh Place



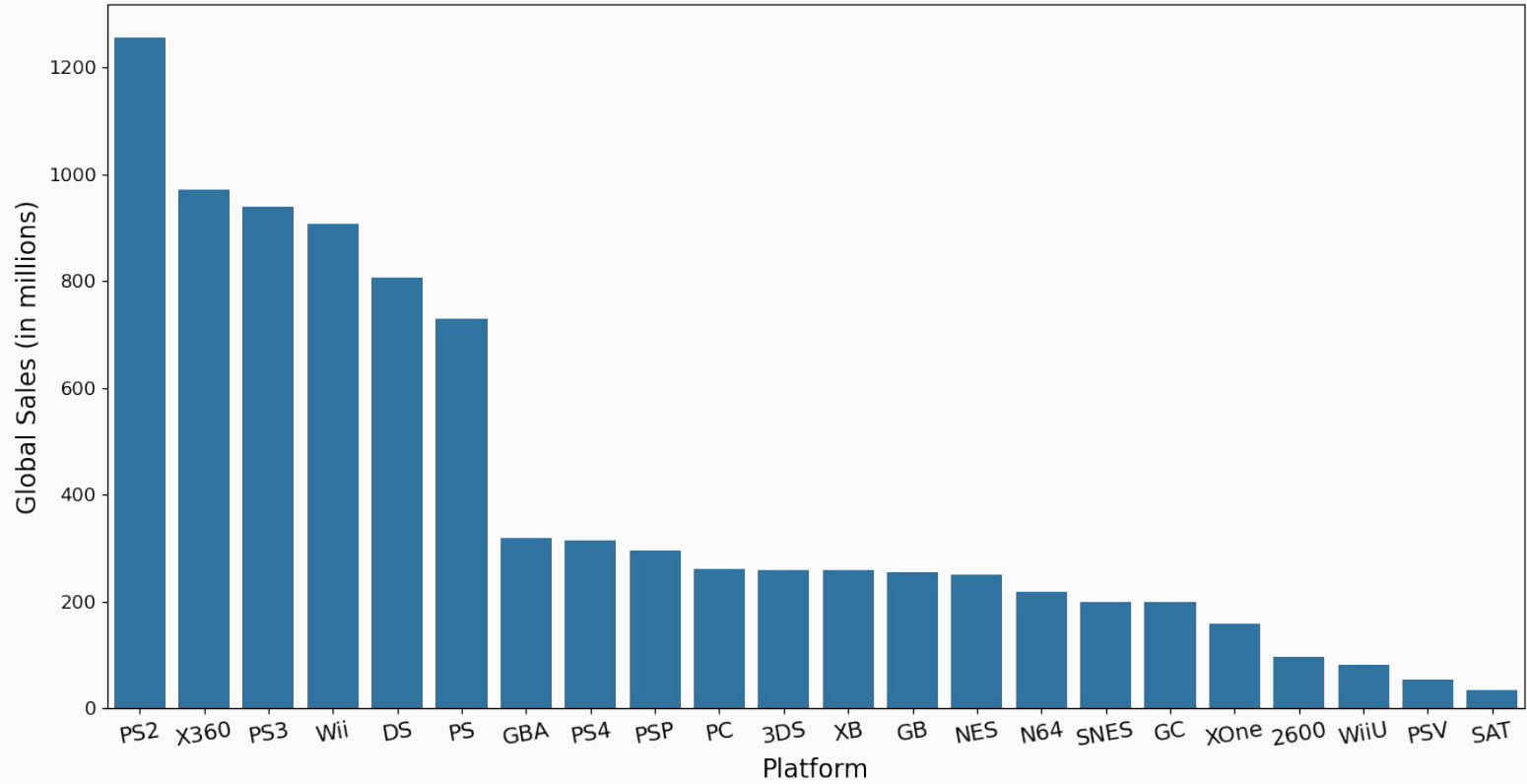
Introductions

The Wii U was Nintendo's sixth home video game console and the successor to the Wii, released in 2012 and went on to compete against Sony's Playstation 4 and Microsoft's XBOX One, both of which released next year. While the console achieved a niche demographic among Nintendo fans, it was unfortunately labeled as a commercial failure by journalists, analytics, and even Nintendo themselves.

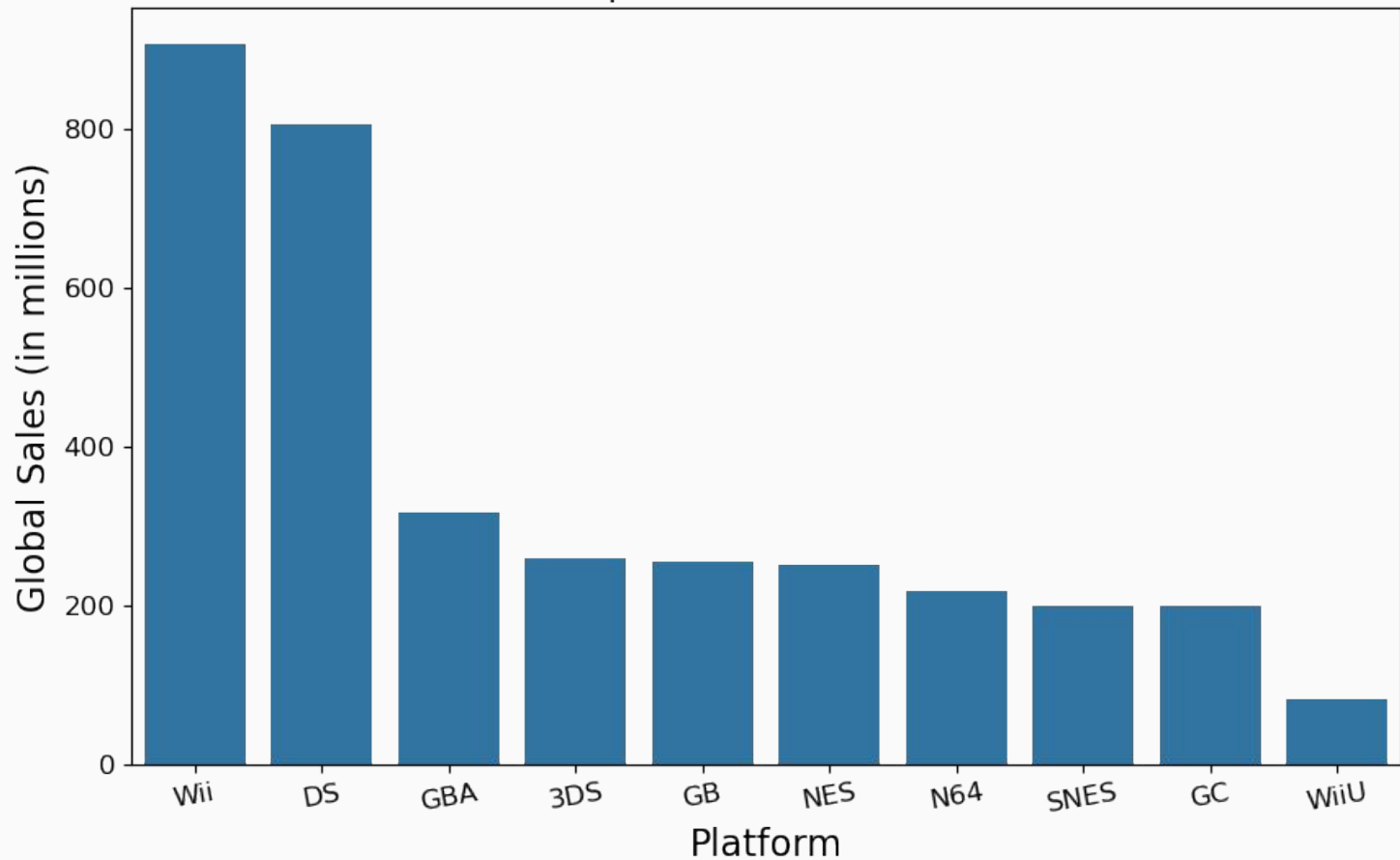
Which begs the question...

Did a lack of major third party support attribute to lower sales of games on the Wii U, especially when compared to the sales of games on other consoles released from 1980 to 2017?

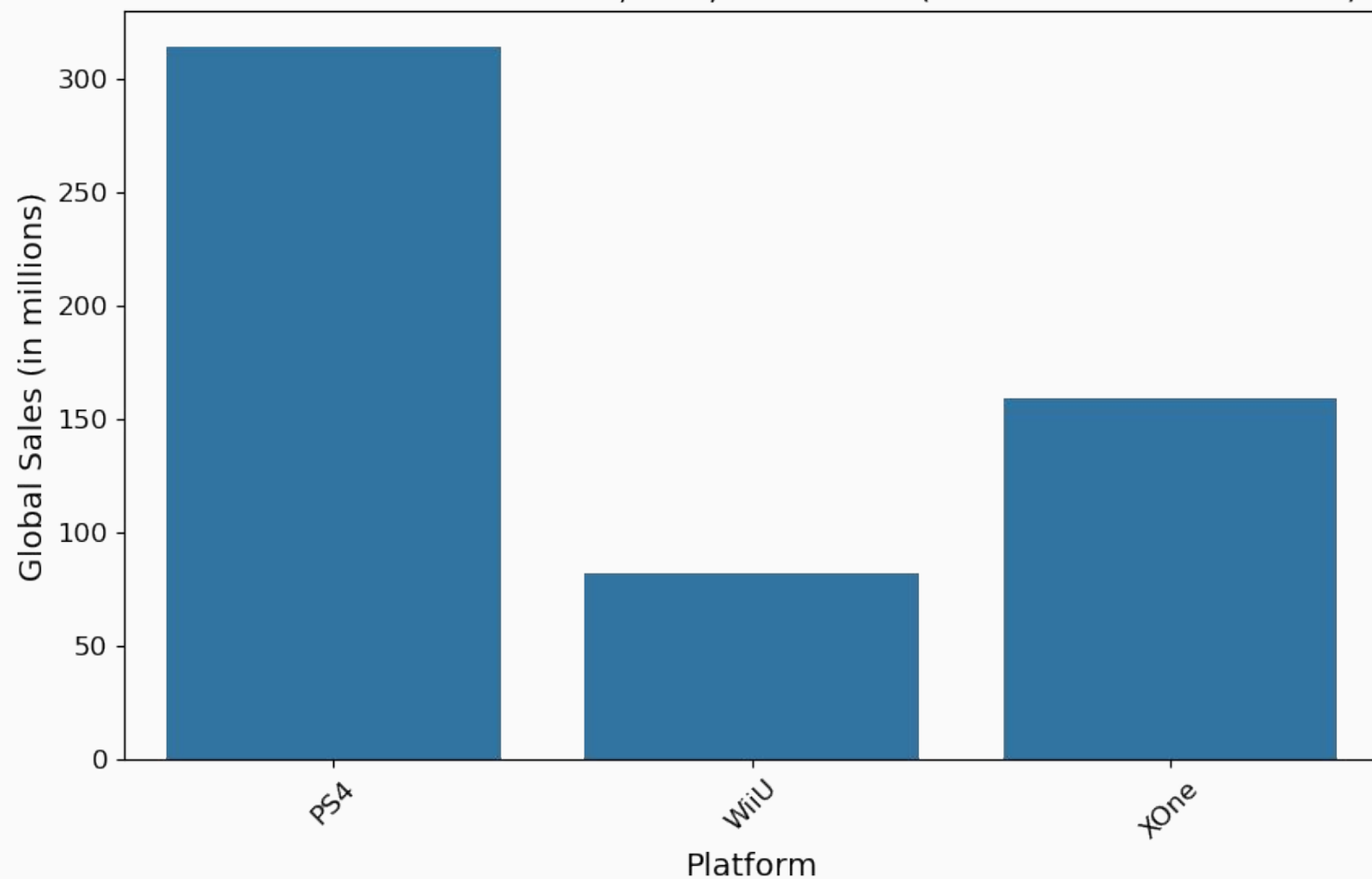
Total Global Sales for Games per Console (before the end of 2016)



Total Global Sales for Games per Nintendo Console (before the end of 2016)



Total Global Sales for WiiU, PS4, and XOne (before the end of 2016)



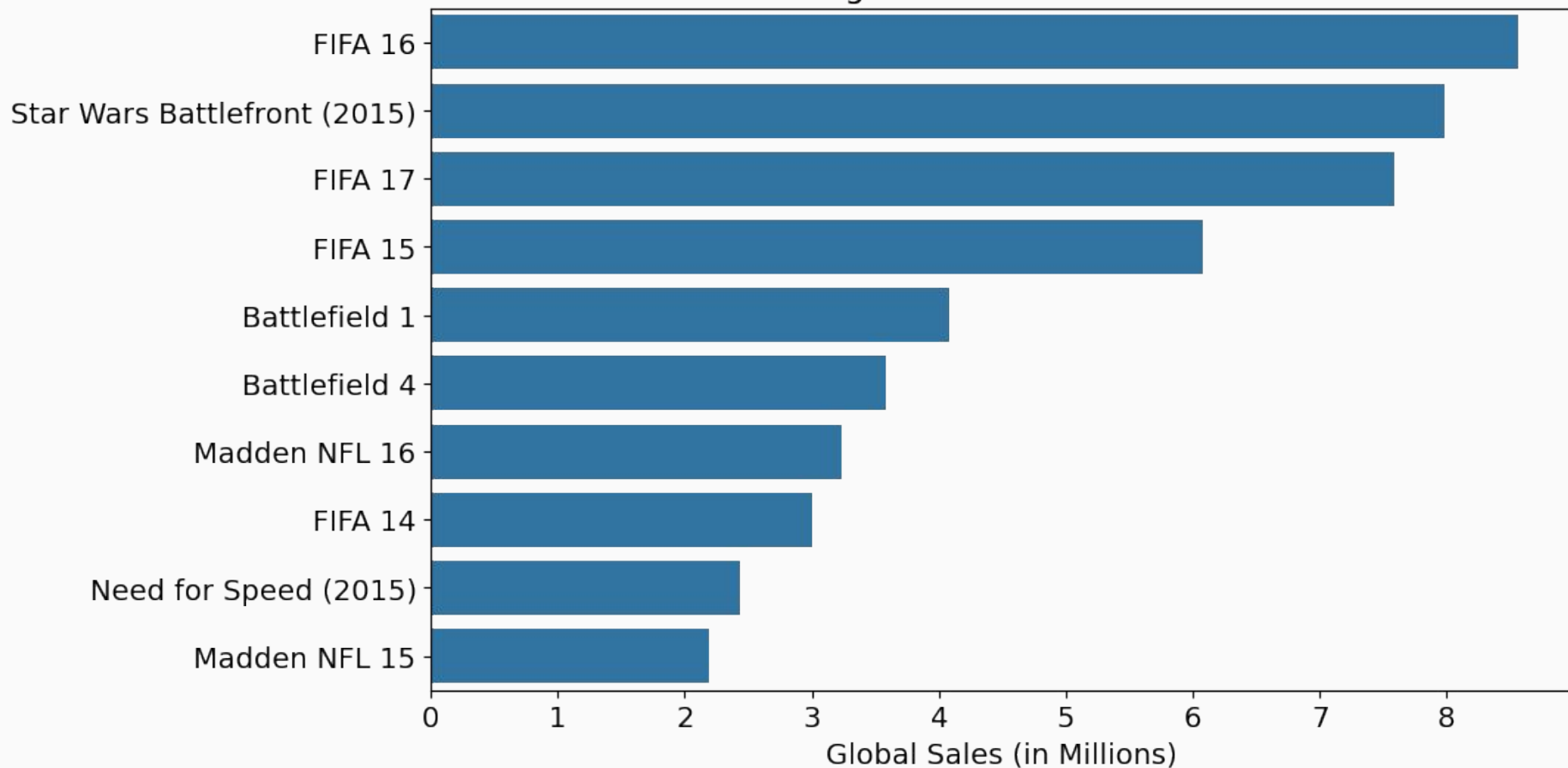
Third-Party Support

Major reasons for lack of third-party support on the Wii U:

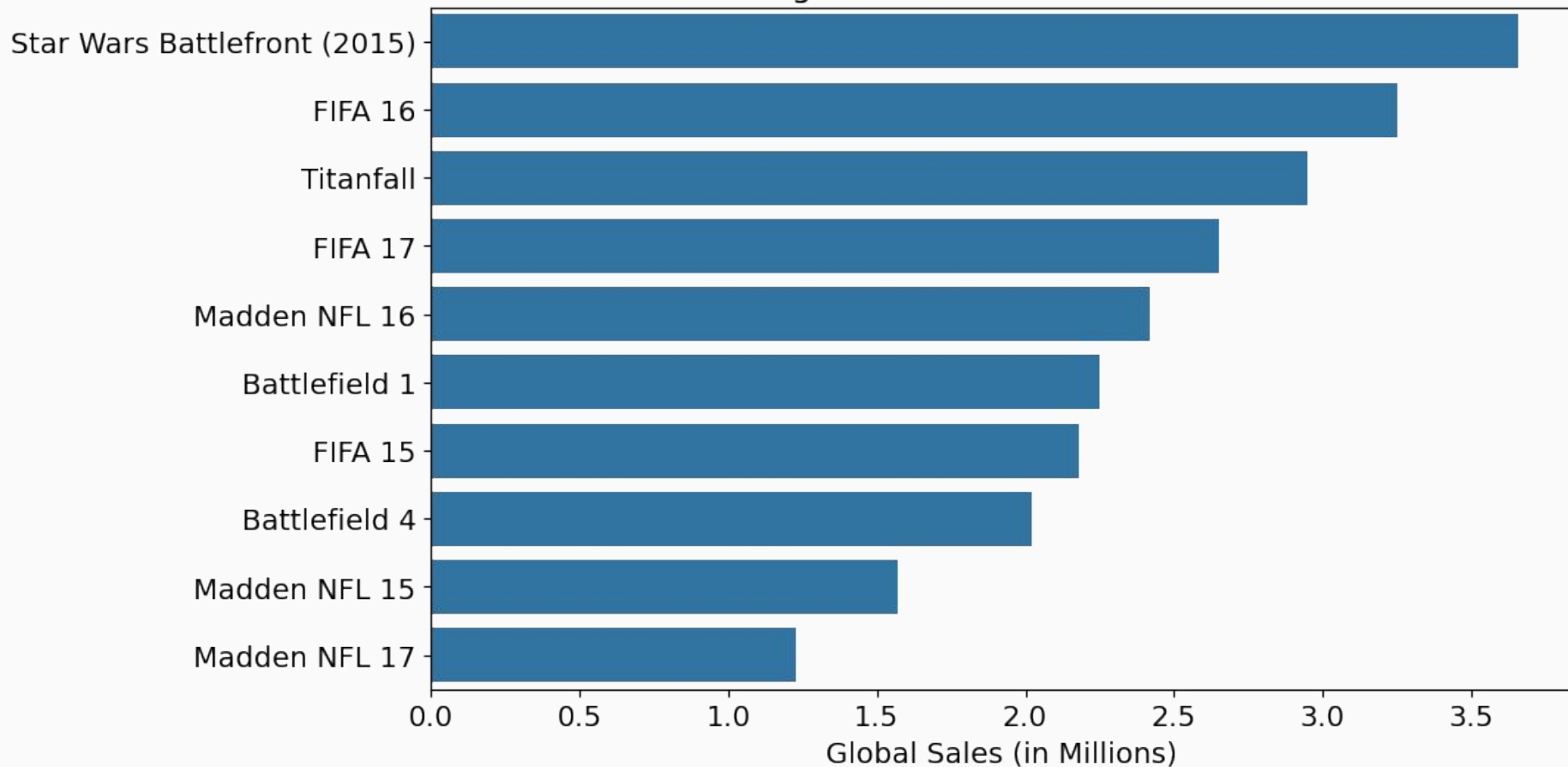
- Lack of modern engine support (i.e. Unreal Engine 4)
- Lower processing power
- Poor marketing

With this in mind, let's take a look at the sales of games released on the Wii U, PS4, and XBOX One released by seven of the largest game publishers: Activision, Bethesda, Capcom, EA, Take-Two, Sega and Ubisoft.

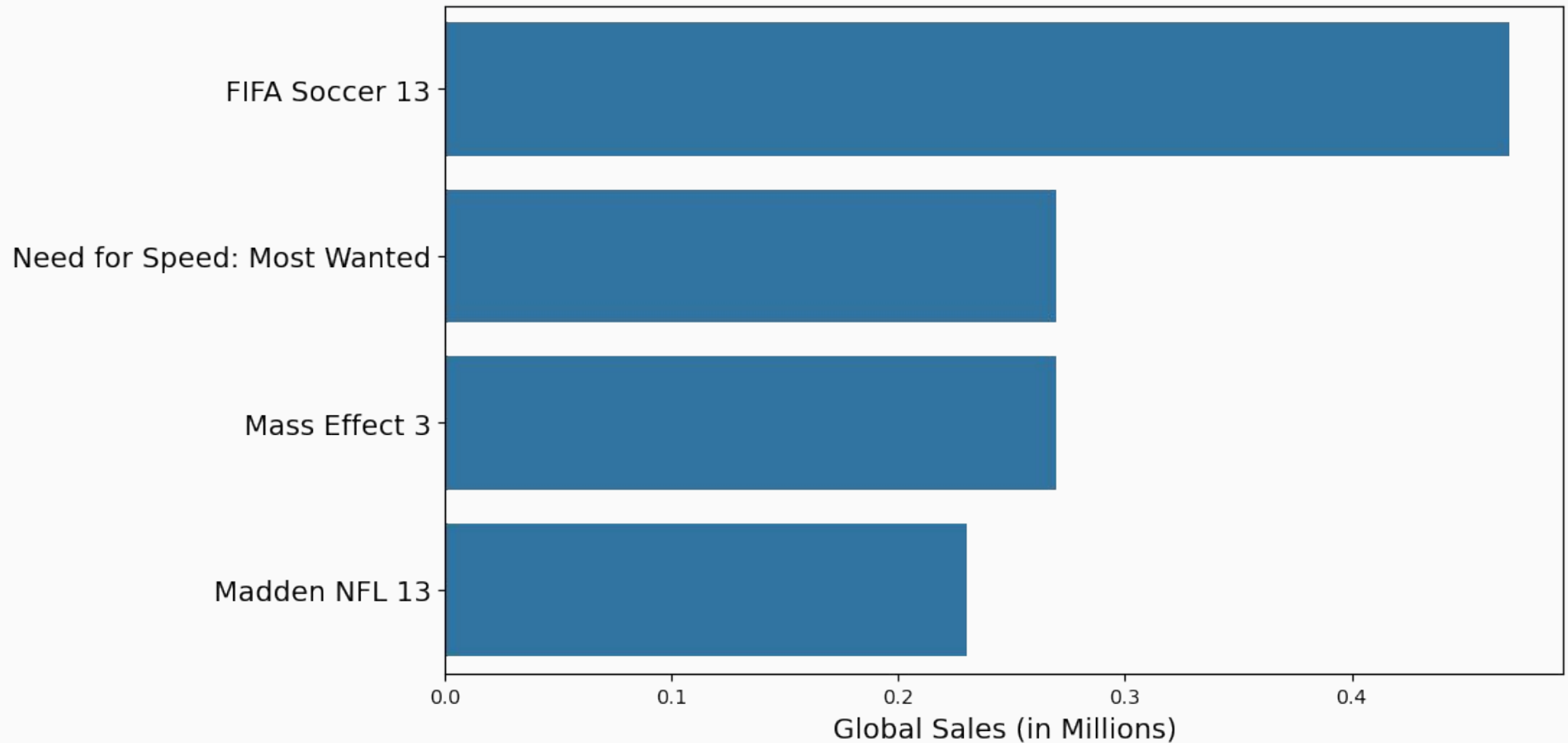
Ten Best Selling EA Games Published on the PS4



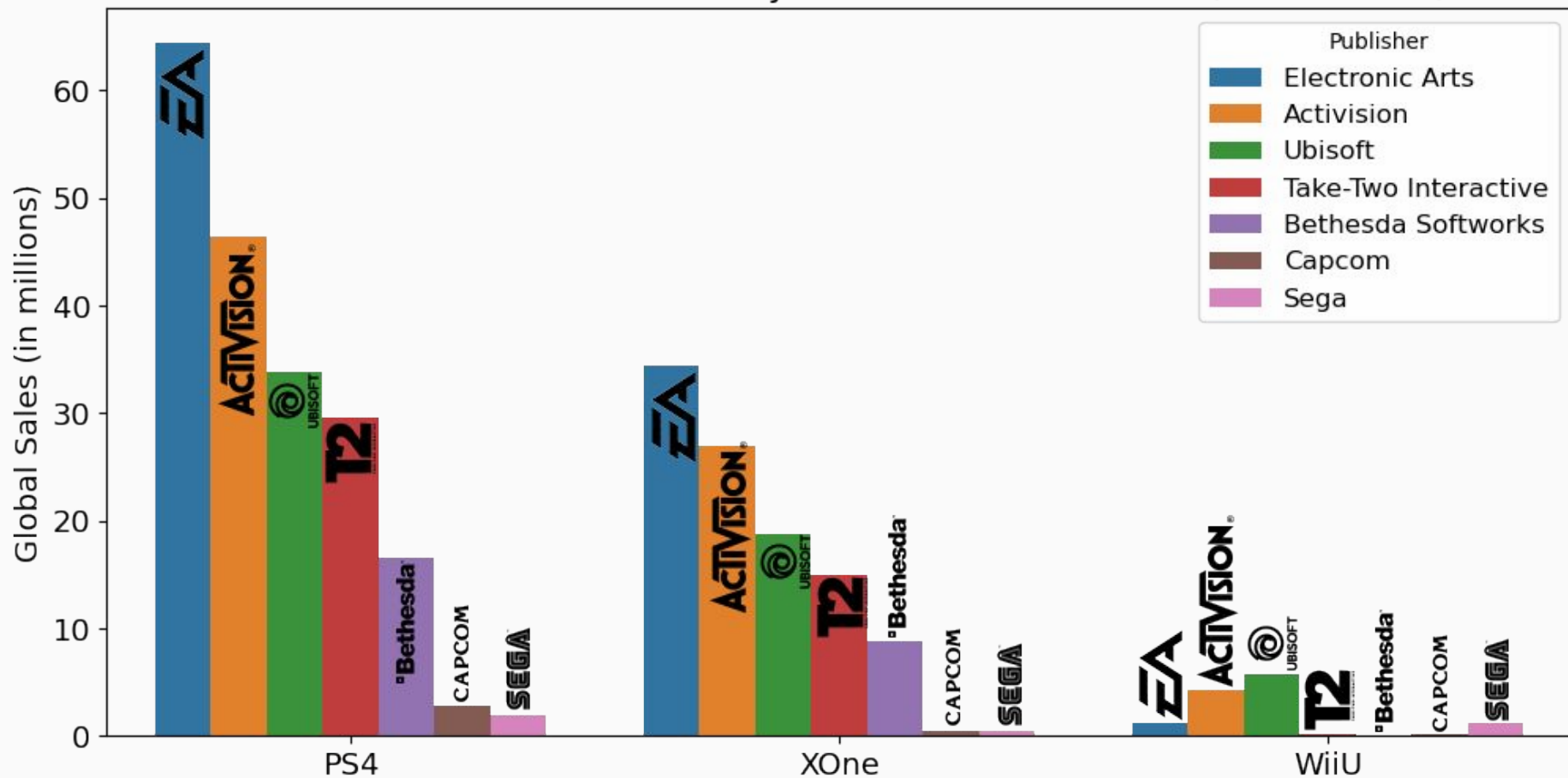
Ten Best Selling EA Games Published on the XBOX One



Sales of EA Games Published on the Wii U



Global Sales of Video Games by Publisher and Platform (before 2017)

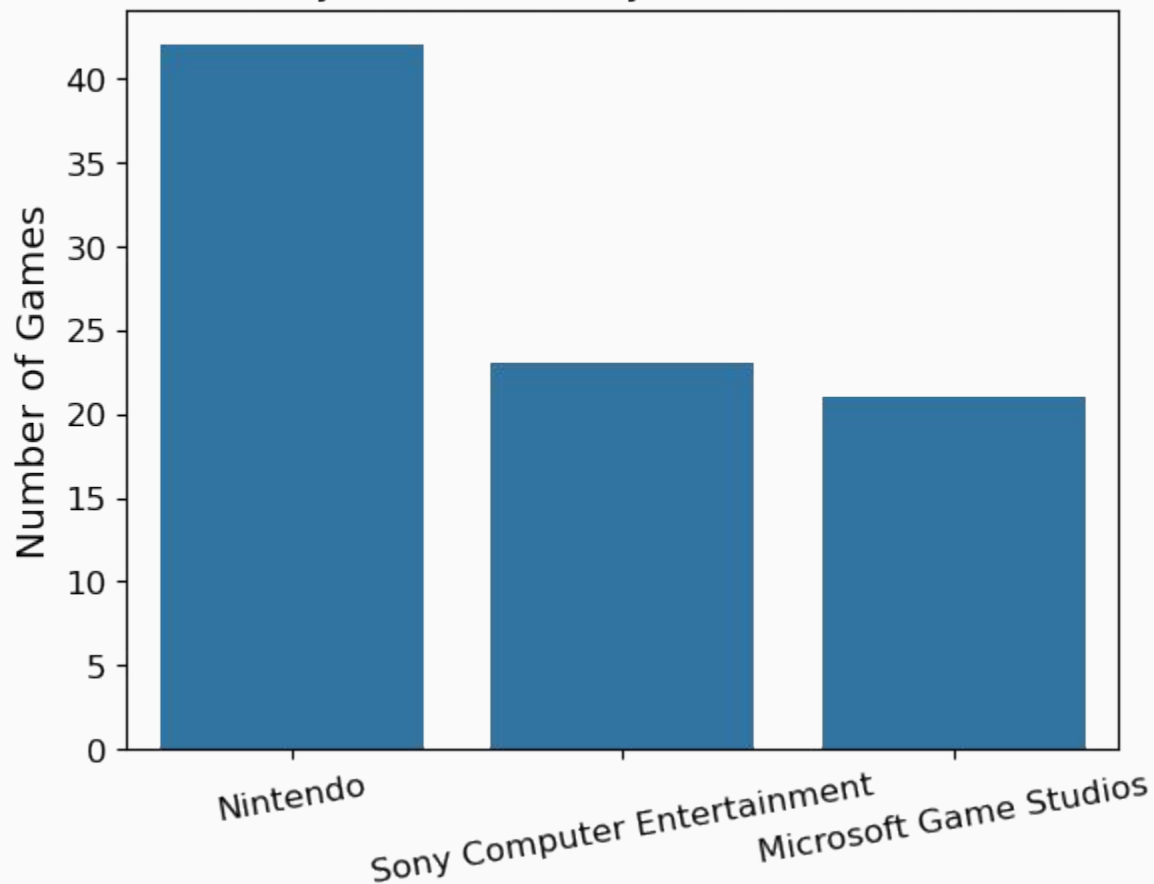


First-Party Support

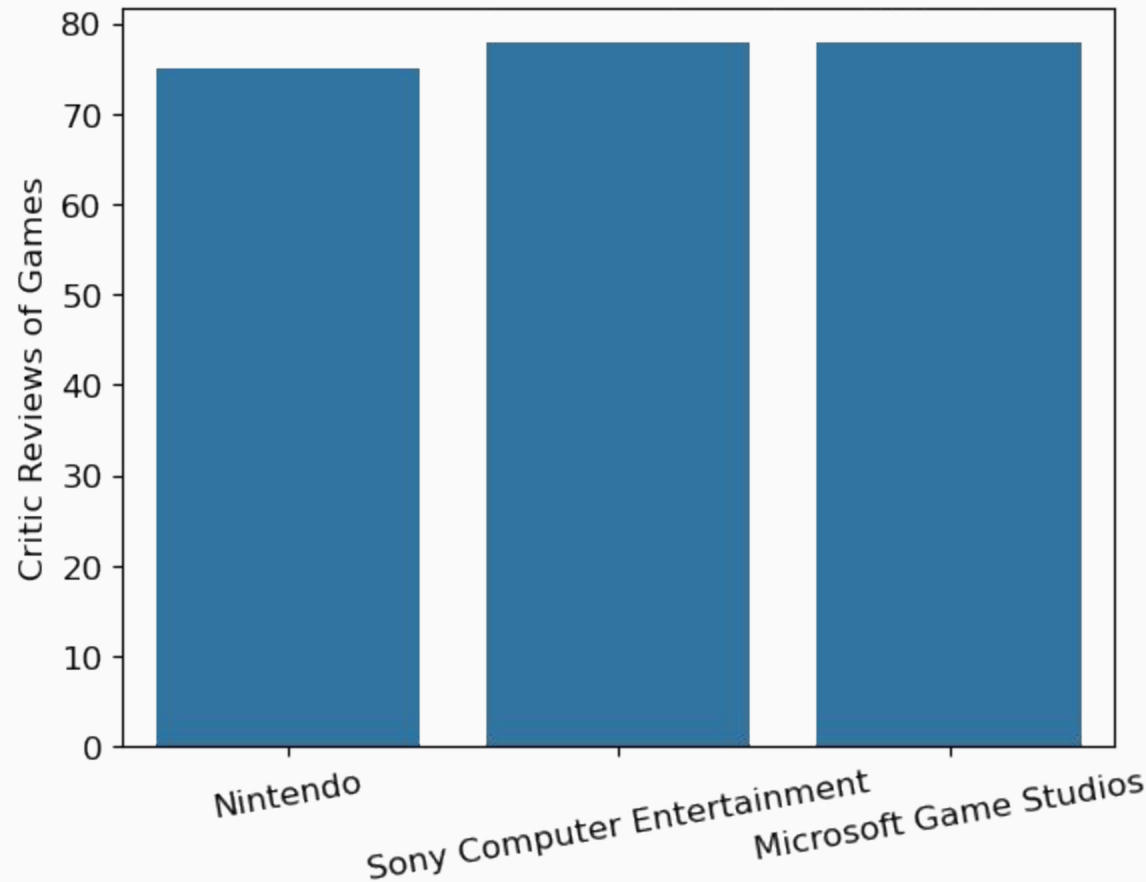
Despite the undeniable lack of third-party support for the Wii U, the console still maintained a niche demographic among Nintendo fans, thanks to not only a commendable library of first party titles, but also a massive library of classic video games that, at the time, weren't available on any other platform.

Let's compare the output and sales of first-party games on the Wii U, PS4, and XBOX One.

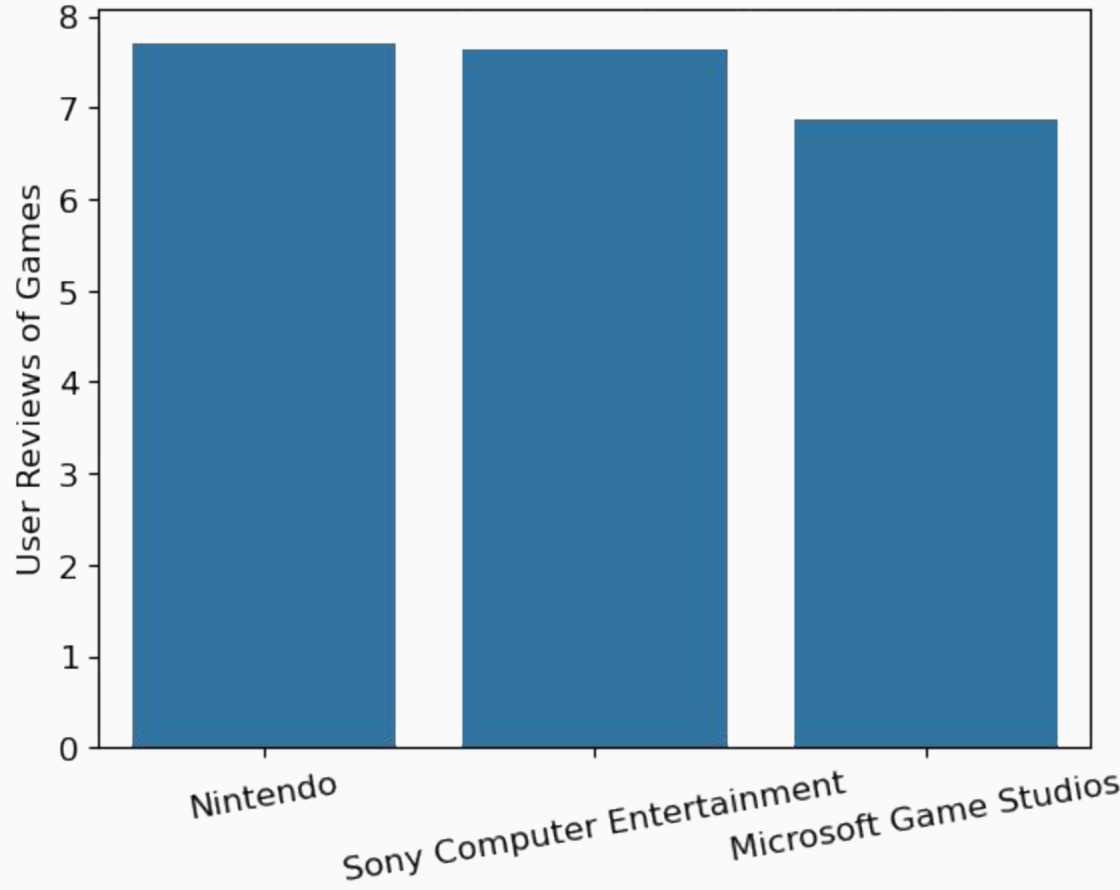
Number of Games Published by Nintendo, Sony, and Microsoft on Their Respective Consoles



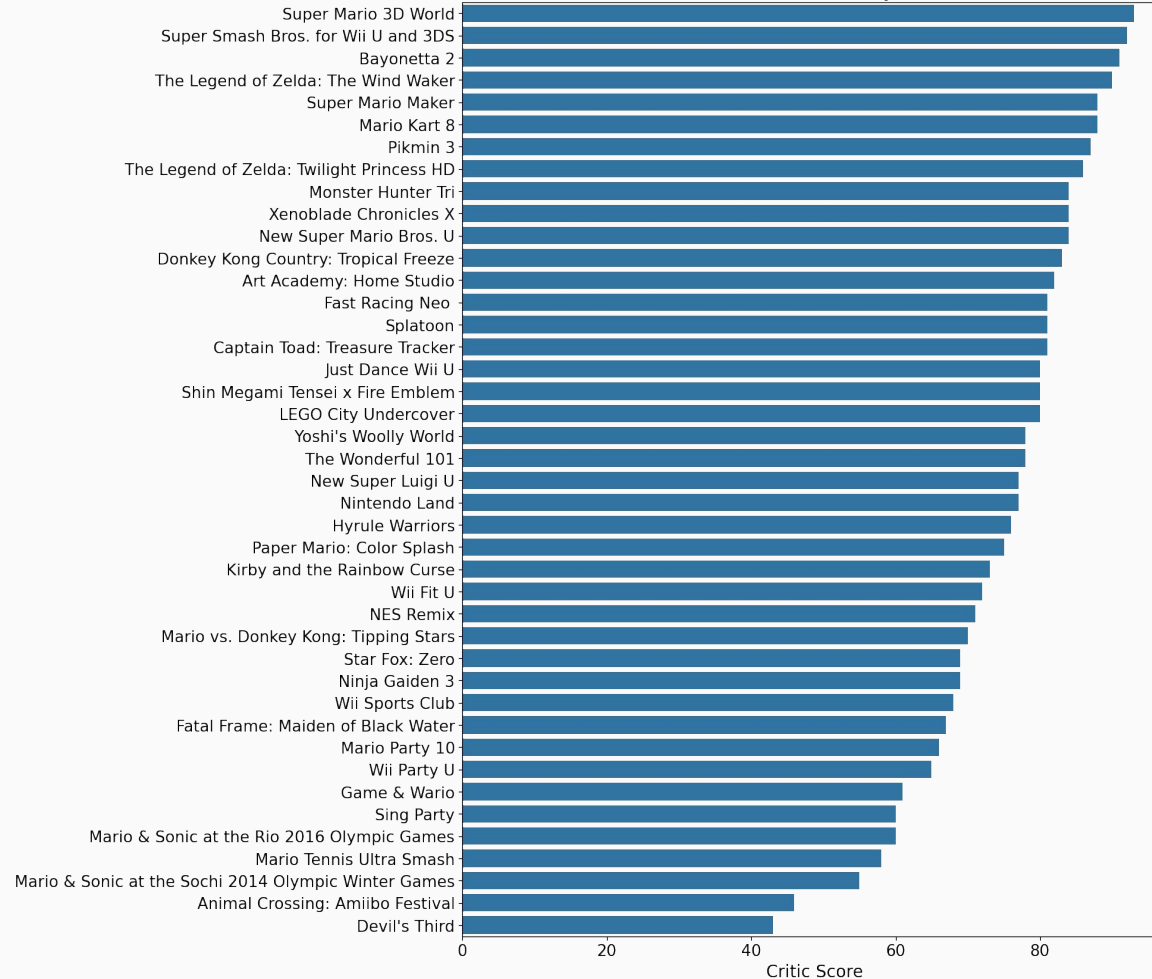
Critic Reviews of Games Published by Nintendo (Wii U), Sony (PS4), and Microsoft (XOne)



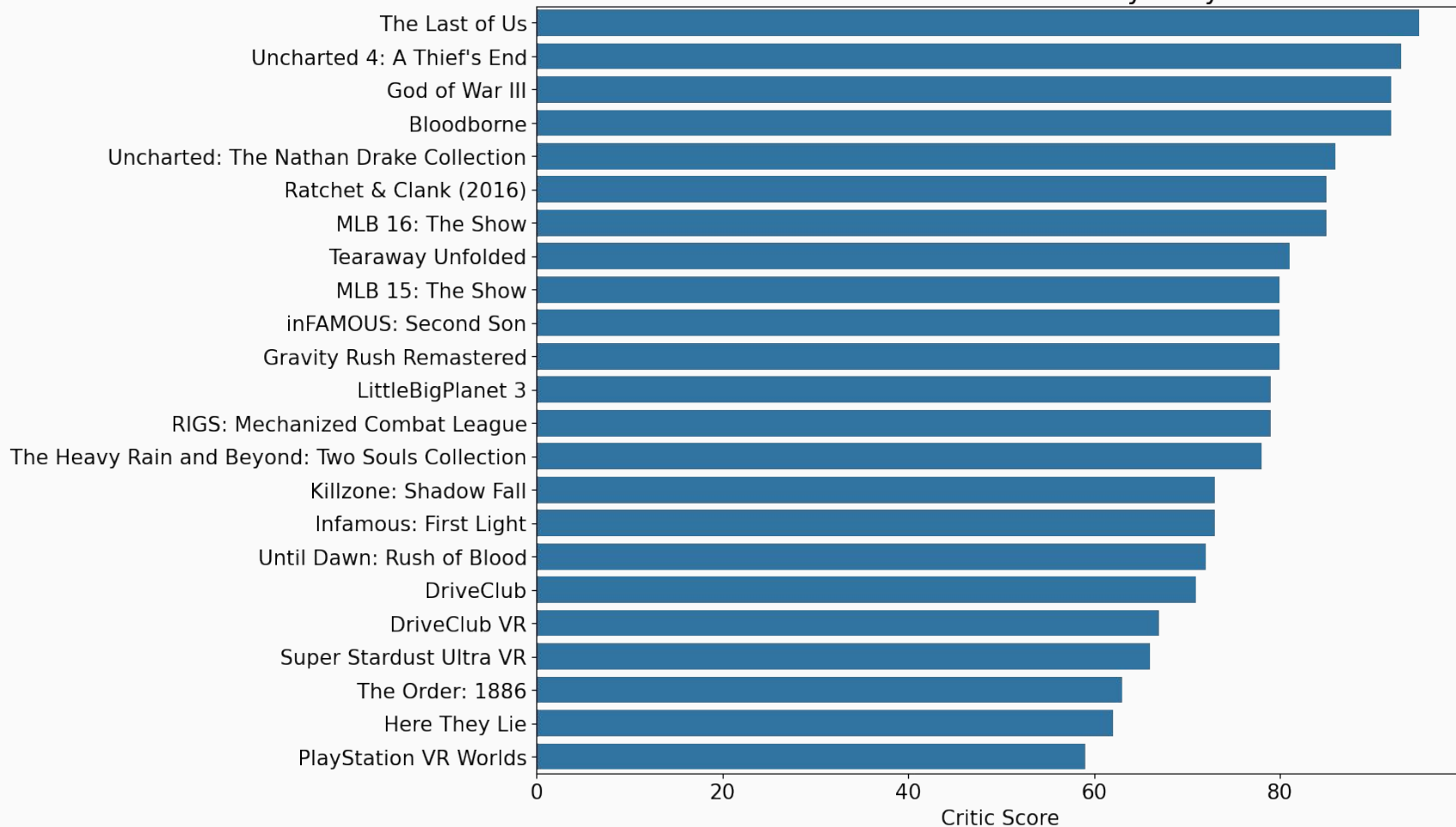
User Reviews of Games Published by Nintendo (Wii U), Sony (PS4), and Microsoft (XOne)



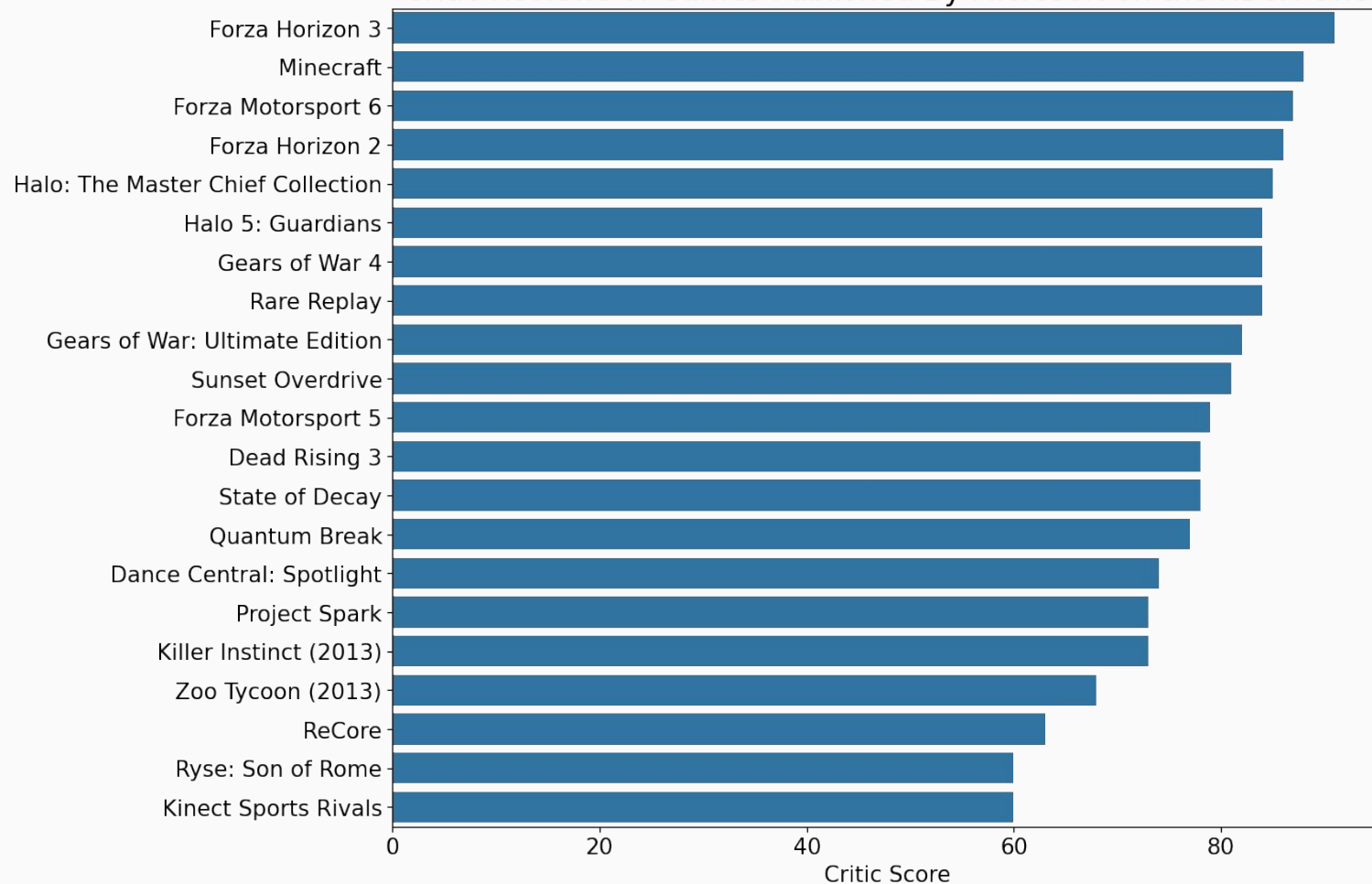
Critic Reviews of Games Published By Nintendo on the Wii U



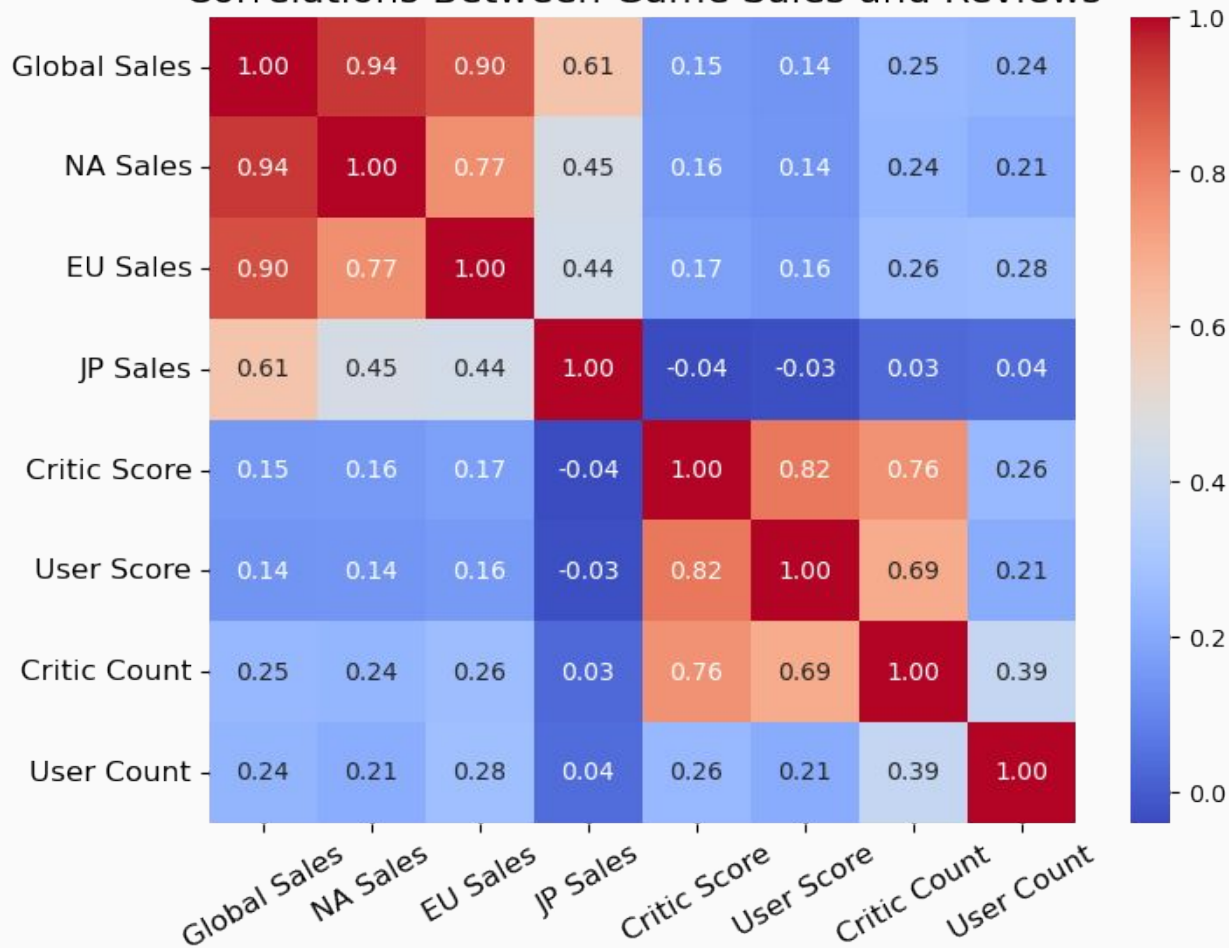
Critic Reviews of Games Published By Sony on the PS4



Critic Reviews of Games Published By Microsoft on the XBOX One



Correlations Between Game Sales and Reviews



In conclusion

Even if the Wii U is looked upon fondly by Nintendo fans, many contributing factors led to third-party companies not wanting to take the risk of publishing their games on the console. It is important to note that for future analyses, the data of consoles that came out after the Wii U should be considered, as well as looking into specific demographics of players.

Sources

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